CYAFA

OFFICIAL PROGRAMME FRAMEWORK

CYAFA Scholarship Framework

Programme framework and scholarship categories

Supporting access to education, protecting vulnerable learners, and developing the potential of children and young people.

IMPLEMENTATION FOCUS

Magwi County, South Sudan

Proposed support from donors and sponsors, including the People of Obbo Overseas — USA, Canada, Australia and beyond

Document status: For review and formal approval by CYAFA's authorized governing body

CHILDREN AND YOUTHS' ADVOCATE FOUNDATION IN AFRICA

CYAFA – SOUTH SUDAN

Empowering People • Strengthening Communities

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document title	CYAFA Scholarship Framework
Responsible organization	Children and Youths' Advocate Foundation in Africa (CYAFA)
Implementation area	Magwi County, South Sudan
Responsible unit	CYAFA Management / designated Scholarship Committee
Approval status	For review and formal approval
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Review cycle	Periodic review as determined by CYAFA

1. INTRODUCTION

The Children and Youths' Advocate Foundation in Africa (CYAFA) recognizes education as a pathway to protection, dignity, opportunity, and community development. Poverty, parental loss, disability, emergencies, gender-related barriers, and other difficult circumstances can prevent children and young people from attending school or completing their studies.

This framework establishes a structured approach for identifying eligible learners, assessing educational needs, mobilizing support, and allocating scholarship assistance transparently. The framework applies to Magwi County as a whole and is not limited to any single payam or community. Donors and sponsors who join the programme may choose the scholarship category they wish to support, and the category chosen determines the eligibility criteria that apply. Expansion beyond Magwi County may be considered as resources and capacity permit.

2. PURPOSE

To guide CYAFA in developing and administering scholarship support that helps vulnerable and deserving learners access, continue, and progress through education or recognized vocational training.

3. OBJECTIVES

- Reduce financial barriers that prevent vulnerable learners from accessing or completing education.
- Prioritize children and young people who have lost both parents and lack adequate financial support.
- Promote equitable access for girls, learners with disabilities, and other underserved groups.
- Recognize academic commitment, talent, and potential where appropriate.

- Support young people pursuing recognized technical and vocational training.
- Mobilize community, diaspora, institutional, and private-sector support.
- Establish transparent selection, safeguarding, monitoring, and accountability procedures.

4. GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Equity and need: Prioritize vulnerability, financial hardship, and risk of educational disruption.

Fairness and transparency: Document and consistently apply criteria; manage conflicts of interest.

Child safeguarding: Let the safety, dignity, and best interests of children guide every stage.

Inclusion: Assess applicants without discrimination unrelated to published criteria.

Accountability: Record funds and in-kind assistance and use them for approved educational purposes.

Privacy and dignity: Collect sensitive information only when necessary and handle it confidentially.

Sustainability: Keep awards within confirmed resources; do not promise an amount or duration without approval.

5. SCHOLARSHIP CATEGORIES

CYAFA may administer the categories below according to assessed need, donor preferences, available funding, and organizational capacity. Establishing a category does not itself guarantee funding. Donors and sponsors may select the category they wish to support; the category selected determines the eligibility criteria applied to the learners supported.

5.1 Orphans and Extremely Vulnerable Children Scholarship — Flagship

Supports learners who have lost both parents and face serious financial hardship or lack adequate support to continue education. Proposed as the flagship category of the programme.

Possible support: School or tuition fees, uniforms, books, learning materials, examination fees, and other approved essential educational costs.

5.2 Financially Disadvantaged Students Scholarship

Supports learners from households experiencing severe financial hardship whose education is at risk, whether or not they have lost a parent.

Possible support: Fees, learning materials, uniforms, examination costs, and other approved educational needs.

5.3 Girls' Education Scholarship

Helps girls facing financial or other barriers to enrolment, attendance, retention, or completion of education.

Possible support: School costs, learning materials, and other appropriate educational necessities.

5.4 Academic Excellence and Talent Scholarship

Recognizes learners who demonstrate strong academic performance, commitment, or exceptional potential. Financial need and funding availability may also be considered.

Possible support: Education costs, learning resources, academic enrichment, and approved talent-development opportunities.

5.5 University and Tertiary Education Scholarship

Supports eligible students pursuing recognized university, college, diploma, or other post-secondary qualifications who cannot meet essential education costs.

Possible support: Tuition, registration, approved learning resources, and essential study expenses.

5.6 Technical and Vocational Skills Scholarship

Supports young people undertaking recognized technical, vocational, or practical skills training to improve employment and livelihood opportunities.

Possible support: Training fees, required tools, protective equipment, and learning materials.

5.7 Inclusive Education Scholarship

Supports learners with disabilities or additional learning needs who face barriers to accessing education.

Possible support: Education costs, accessible learning materials, assistive devices, and reasonable accommodations, subject to assessment and funding.

5.8 Emergency Education Support Scholarship

Provides time-sensitive assistance when displacement, conflict, loss of a caregiver, or sudden household hardship threatens a learner's education.

Possible support: Urgent fees, replacement learning materials, examination costs, and other verified essential expenses.

6. PRIORITY AND ELIGIBILITY

CYAFA should publish eligibility requirements for each category and application round. The category supported by a donor or sponsor determines the eligibility criteria that apply. For the Orphans and Extremely Vulnerable Children category in Magwi County, applicants should ordinarily:

- Be from Magwi County or meet the geographic requirements announced by CYAFA.
- Have lost both parents, with circumstances confirmed sensitively through appropriate means.
- Experience serious financial hardship and lack adequate support for essential education costs.
- Be enrolled in, admitted to, or seeking to continue at a recognized educational institution.
- Provide relevant application information and available supporting evidence.
- Agree to reasonable follow-up on attendance, progress, and use of support, with age-appropriate consent and safeguards.

Other categories use their own criteria, set out when the category is announced and agreed with the donor or sponsor where applicable, and always consistent with the principles of this framework. Academic grades should not be the sole criterion where a category exists primarily to address extreme vulnerability. Where formal documents are difficult to obtain, alternative verification may be considered if safe and approved.

7. APPLICATION AND SELECTION PROCESS

7.1 Announcement

CYAFA communicates categories, eligibility, procedures, deadlines if applicable, and contact details. Award numbers and amounts should be announced only when confirmed.

7.2 Application

Applications may be submitted by the learner or, where appropriate, a parent, guardian, caregiver, school representative, or authorized community representative.

7.3 Verification

Designated staff or a Scholarship Committee reviews and verifies relevant information respectfully and confidentially.

7.4 Assessment

Assess applications against published criteria, considering vulnerability, financial need, risk of educational disruption, educational status, and category-specific requirements.

7.5 Decision and notification

Record decisions and reasons and inform applicants appropriately. Meeting criteria does not guarantee an award.

7.6 Review request

Provide a simple process for review where an applicant believes information was overlooked or procedure was not followed.

7.7 Conflict of interest

Committee members disclose personal or financial interests and do not participate where impartiality may be affected.

8. TYPES OF SUPPORT AND DURATION

Assistance may be financial, in-kind, or a combination, based on verified educational needs and confirmed resources. Where practical, payments should be made directly to schools, training providers, or approved suppliers, with appropriate receipts and records.

The scholarship programme is intended to operate as a continuing initiative rather than having a pre-set end date. Individual awards are not automatically permanent: continuation depends on ongoing eligibility, relevant educational progress, periodic review, compliance with programme conditions, and funding availability. Any specific commitment must be clearly explained and approved before it is made.

9. ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

STAKEHOLDER	KEY RESPONSIBILITY
CYAFA governing body / Board	Approve the framework, oversee governance and risk, and review programme performance.
CYAFA management	Coordinate implementation, partnerships, procedures, and resource controls.
Scholarship Committee	Assess applications, document decisions, manage conflicts, and recommend awards.
Schools and training institutions	Confirm enrollment, relevant costs, and appropriate progress information when authorized.
Caregivers and community representatives	Help eligible learners access information and application support without improperly influencing decisions.
Donors and sponsors	Provide funds or in-kind support under agreed terms and receive privacy-respecting reports.

STAKEHOLDER	KEY RESPONSIBILITY
Scholarship recipients	Use support for approved purposes, provide reasonable progress information, and report relevant changes.

10. FUNDING AND DONOR ENGAGEMENT

CYAFA may seek support from the People of Obbo living overseas, including in the United States of America, Canada, Australia, and other countries, as well as individuals, charitable foundations, businesses, civil society organizations, and institutional donors.

- Donors may support a category, general scholarship fund, or individual learner where consistent with CYAFA policy and safeguarding requirements. The category a donor or sponsor selects determines the eligibility criteria and the learners who may be supported.
- Donor preferences must not override fair selection, child safeguarding, or published eligibility criteria.
- Contributions and expenditures must be recorded and managed under CYAFA's financial procedures.
- CYAFA must not promise assistance before funds or resources are available.
- Donor reports should protect children's identities and sensitive circumstances unless appropriate consent and safeguards permit disclosure.

11. SAFEGUARDING, PRIVACY AND COMPLAINTS

Applications must be handled to protect applicants' dignity, safety, and privacy, especially children. Information about parental loss, poverty, disability, or other sensitive circumstances must be restricted to authorized persons who need it for assessment or programme delivery. Photographs, stories, and identifying details must not be used for publicity or fundraising without appropriate informed consent and safeguards.

Applicants should have a safe way to ask questions, raise concerns, or report misconduct, discrimination, exploitation, or misuse of funds. Complaints should be recorded and handled promptly, impartially, and confidentially, with referral to appropriate protection services where necessary.

12. MONITORING, REPORTING AND ACCOUNTABILITY

CYAFA should maintain accurate records of applications, assessments, decisions, award values or in-kind support, payments, verification, and follow-up. Monitoring should be proportionate and avoid unnecessary burdens on learners and families.

- Applications received, assessed, approved, and declined by category.

- Award distribution by education level, gender, location, and vulnerability, using privacy-protective reporting.
- Attendance, retention, continuation, or completion information where appropriate.
- Funds received, spent, and committed, supported by financial records.
- Feedback, complaints, lessons learned, and corrective actions.

13. REVIEW AND AMENDMENT

This framework should be reviewed periodically and when material changes occur in programme scope, funding, safeguarding requirements, or operating context. Amendments must be approved by CYAFA's authorized governing body and communicated to relevant stakeholders.

14. FORMAL APPROVAL

This framework is submitted for review and approval by the authorized governing body of CYAFA. It becomes an official organizational framework upon approval and completion of the details below.

Approved by (name and title) _____

Signature _____

Date of approval _____

Official stamp _____

ANNEX 1: SUGGESTED APPLICATION FILE CHECKLIST

- Completed application form or recorded application interview.
- Student identity and contact details, handled securely.
- School or training institution and educational status.
- Description of financial hardship and educational needs.
- Appropriate verification of parental loss or other vulnerability, where relevant and safe.
- Estimated educational costs or confirmation from the institution.
- Assessment record and conflict-of-interest declaration.
- Decision record, notification, and award acknowledgment.
- Payment or in-kind assistance record and follow-up notes.

ANNEX 2: IMPLEMENTATION NOTE

Before implementation, CYAFA should approve operational details, including application forms, scoring criteria, verification procedures, financial controls, safeguarding and complaints pathways, donor reporting arrangements, and category-specific requirements. Award numbers, values, application deadlines, and budgets should be announced only after formal determination.